

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



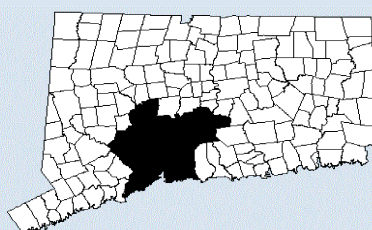
Area Cooperative Educational Services

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District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	12
Enrollment	1,719
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$49,216
Total Expenditures ¹	\$98,678,783

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.3
Male	1,005	58.5	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.2
Asian	44	2.6	5.2
Black or African American	572	33.3	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	567	33.0	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	95	5.5	4.7
White	434	25.2	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	91	5.3	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	788	45.8	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	774	45.0	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	215	31.9	107	14.3
Male	398	38.1	241	21.3
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0	*
Black or African American	203	35.2	133	21.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	240	42.6	123	19.7
White	110	25.2	62	13.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	42	45.7	8	7.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	388	44.1	196	20.4
Students with Disabilities	401	47.3	164	17.6
District	613	35.7	348	18.5
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 552

Number of school-based arrests: 8

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	103.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	37.4
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	87.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	300.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.0
School Level	20.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	20.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	33.3
School Nurses	16.5
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	215.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	5	1.7	1.4
Black or African American	21	7.0	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	11	3.7	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.3
White	262	87.6	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	14.1	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	16	59.3	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	11	*	20	45.5
White	*	*	19	27.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	22	64.7	31	39.7
Students with Disabilities	30	54.5	54	34.2
District	30	54.5	54	34.2
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	N/A	N/A	2.6
Emotional Disability	N/A	N/A	1.1
Intellectual Disability	N/A	N/A	0.6
Learning Disability	N/A	N/A	6.4
Other Health Impairment	N/A	N/A	3.5
Other Disabilities	N/A	N/A	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	N/A	N/A	2.0
All Disabilities	N/A	N/A	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	N/A	N/A	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	N/A	N/A	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$43,192,437	\$21,542	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$17,334,143	\$8,645	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$1,299,951	\$648	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$5,369,588	\$2,678	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$5,093,466	\$2,540	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$8,610,639	\$4,295	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$9,567,039	\$4,772	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$8,211,520	\$4,564	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$98,678,783	\$49,216	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$8,763,886	16.1	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$7,716,247	14.2	10.2
Other Salaries	\$19,760,264	36.4	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$11,397,657	21.0	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$552,995	1.0	6.4
Special Education Tuition	.	.	22.2
Supplies	\$1,990,381	3.7	0.7
Property Services	\$2,353,198	4.3	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$7,000	0.0	8.4
Equipment	\$1,764,678	3.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$47,780	0.1	0.1
Total	\$54,354,087	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		55.1	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	84.2
State	13.3
Federal	2.5
Tuition & Other	.

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

Area Cooperative Educational Services

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	30	59.0	30	58.6	*	*
Black or African American	361	46.7	354	39.9	160	42.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	383	52.6	380	46.6	159	52.2
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	68	52.4	67	47.6	32	50.3
White	288	60.9	287	58.7	104	62.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	81	51.0	81	47.1	22	52.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	1,052	53.1	1,040	48.0	443	50.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	496	49.2	487	43.4	213	47.9
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	637	55.9	634	51.4	252	53.5
Students with Disabilities	385	36.7	377	31.2	164	34.1
Students without Disabilities	748	61.3	744	56.4	301	60.1
High Needs	718	46.5	707	40.8	307	43.9
Non-High Needs	415	64.1	414	60.1	158	64.5
District	1,133	52.9	1,121	47.9	465	50.9

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	76.8	79.5	84.1	39.3	625	77.8
Curl Up	75.0	81.4	77.9	58.9	608	77.0
Push Up	66.7	67.7	72.3	23.2	612	65.7
Mile Run/PACER	76.1	77.1	68.8	0.0	610	66.2
All Tests - District	54.1	49.2	48.8	0.0	596	45.1
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	N/A	N/A
Hispanic or Latino of any race	N/A	N/A
White	N/A	N/A
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	N/A	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	N/A	N/A
Students with Disabilities	N/A	N/A
District	N/A	N/A
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	0	0.0
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	0	0.0
White	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	*	*
Male	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*
White	*	*
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	*	*
District	*	*
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	52.9	75	35.3	50	70.6	63.9
	High Needs Students	46.5	75	31.0	50	62.0	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	47.9	75	31.9	50	63.9	60.2
	High Needs Students	40.8	75	27.2	50	54.4	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	50.9	75	34.0	50	67.9	61.8
	High Needs Students	43.9	75	29.3	50	58.6	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	48.5%	100%	48.5	100	48.5	58.7%
	High Needs Students	45.9%	100%	45.9	100	45.9	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	57.6%	100%	57.6	100	57.6	61.4%
	High Needs Students	54.2%	100%	54.2	100	54.2	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.1%	100%	28.6	50	57.1	58.9%
	Oral	58.0%	100%	29.0	50	58.0	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	35.7%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	17.7%
	High Needs Students	43.0%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	39.4%	75%	26.3	50	52.6	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	0.9%	75%	0.6	50	1.3	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		77.0%	94%	41.0	50	82.0	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		.	75%	.	.	.	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		81.1% 45.1%	75%	15.0	50	30.1	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		5.9%	60%	4.9	50	9.8	55.0%
Accountability Index				540.2	1150	47.0	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	64.1	46.5	17.6	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	60.1	40.8	19.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	64.5	43.9	20.6	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.8
	High Needs Students	95.5
Math	All Students	95.4
	High Needs Students	93.8
Science	All Students	93.9
	High Needs Students	92.2

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 35.4

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Area Cooperative Educational Services (ACES) is the Regional Educational Service Center in south-central Connecticut dedicated to enhancing and transforming lives through education, innovation, and leadership. Our vision is to create an equitable and socially just world, one life at a time, by engaging the community through Open and Magnet School Parent Choice programs and Minority Teacher Recruitment initiatives.

ACES Family and Community Engagement Specialist has begun the mission to empower, engage families and collaborate with community partners to support strong academic and personal development for all students.

In an effort to support surrounding areas and towns, ACES has begun to hold monthly meetings with partnering districts and visit employment and mental health agencies within the surrounding area in order to increase our knowledge of community-based resources.

1st ACES Resource Fair was developed in an effort to invite in community partners to provide district schools an opportunity to increase their knowledge of community-based resources. It was a huge success with over 45 guests and 14 agencies.

Welcoming walkthroughs were implemented in schools to achieve the goal of ensuring that families, students and community partners felt welcomed.

Family resource rooms were developed in schools to provide resources for families and students. Resources such as hygiene kits, gently used clothing, and school supplies. Family and Community message boards were created to allow families that visit the school to have knowledge of what is going on in the community. For those parents that do not come into the school, in an effort that all families receive the same information a monthly letter is sent out electronically filled with community resources and events.

Family engagement teams were developed in each of the schools. These teams are composed of students, families, school staff and community partners. The team's purpose is to collaborate, plan and implement activities to engage all families.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

As a Regional Educational Service Center, ACES works with our 25-member school districts to reduce academic and social issues stemming from racial, ethnic, and economic isolation. To reduce racial isolation, ACES operates three interdistrict magnet schools enrolling over 1600 students, coordinates several interdistrict collaborative programs, and facilitates Open Choice for our districts.

ACES magnet schools are designed to attract students across many school districts increasing educational opportunities for students of diverse backgrounds to learn alongside one another. Each school reinforces its diversity mission while delivering a high-quality curriculum with a unique academic focus.

Technology allows students to access their learning through multiple resources and has been said to be a great divide for student learning. We provide state-of-the-art technical support and services for all our students to assist them in their education in person and remotely. Most of our schools offer their students a one-to-one laptop/iPad experience. We are working with local universities to develop laboratory classrooms to support action research in our schools and to support the development of teacher cohorts for our member school districts. Our magnet schools have also had the opportunity to participate with other school districts in the interdistrict grant partnerships. Here, our schools' teachers and students work with fellow schools from other communities. We seek opportunities to partner for technology, math, social studies, science, and Language Arts enrichment.

ACES has been instrumental in Minority Teacher Recruitment (MTR) efforts in CT. The MTR Advisory Council has developed and implemented strategies to increase the number of minority educators, including our highly successful annual MTR Job Fair. As a member of the RESC MTR Alliance, ACES played a crucial role in securing funding from the State Pipeline. ACES now operates a Teacher Residency Program to attract and retain teachers of color.

ACES has an agency-wide Diversity Committee and has hired a Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion Director to provide DEI leadership across the agency.

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Area Cooperative Educational Services

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

ACES is the Regional Educational Service Center for twenty-five school districts in south-central Connecticut. Each local school district appoints a representative to the ACES Governing Board of Education. Our Board works collectively to set a strategic direction for our organization based on the region's educational needs and our school system. ACES operates schools and programs based on these needs, and the Governing Board ensures the equitable allocation of resources among the programs. Each school and program participate in a rigorous budget development process, including ACES Governing Board Approval of resource allocations in every program.

Local funding, State of Connecticut magnet school support, and grant resources are utilized to achieve and enhance equity among our programs. Building level principals and directors meet monthly with ACES Central Administration to discuss issues relating to available resources in meeting their academic goals. This process also assists the district and agency plan for budget development. The budget process includes a committee, the building administrator(s), ACES Central Administration, and the ACES Governing Board.